

Eugene (Yik Ching) WONG

Address

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Education

Ph.D. in Speech-Language-Hearing Sciences

2026

University of Minnesota

Dissertation Title: *How Does Gender Development Intersect with Speech Development? An Interdisciplinary Study of the Acquisition of Gendered Speech*

Dissertation Committee: Benjamin Munson (chair), Matthew Winn, Kerry Ebert, Melissa Koenig

B.A. in Linguistics and Language Technology (First Class Honours)

2016

City University of Hong Kong

Study-abroad program: Autonomous University of Madrid, Spain

Final-year project: *Production of the English Vowels in Cantonese and Japanese Children*

Advisor: Wai-Sum Lee

Research

Research Interests: Acoustics of children's speech; Production, perception and acquisition of sociophonetic variation; Speech imitation; Perceptual bias; Bilingual language development

Invited Publications

Munson, B. & **Wong, E.** Fricatives. *The Oxford Handbook of Research Methods in Sociophonetics*. (manuscript under review).

Peer-Reviewed Publications

Wong, E. & Munson, B. Socially meaningful variation in child-directed speech: Effects of child gender on variation in /s/ and vowel space dispersion. *Language Learning and Development*. (in press).

Wong, E. & Munson, B. (2025). Beyond spectral moments: Validating alternative measures of sibilant fricatives using listener ratings of children's speech. *JASA Express Letters*, 5(10). <https://doi.org/10.1121/10.0039497>

Wong, E., Koeppe, K., Cychosz, M. & Munson, B. (2025). Gendered speech development in early childhood: Evidence from a longitudinal study of vowel and consonant acoustics. *Journal of Child Language*, 53(4), 759–786. <https://doi.org/10.1017/S030500092500011X>

Fung, R. S. Y., & **Wong, E. Y. C.** (2023). Separated and reunified: An apparent time investigation of the voice quality differences between Hong Kong Cantonese and Guangzhou Cantonese. *PloS one*, 18(10), e0293058. <https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0293058>

Conference Presentations

Wong, E. & Munson, B. (2026). Can AXB perception tasks reliably assess children's phonetic imitation of adults? *Meeting of the Acoustical Society of America*. Philadelphia, PA.

Wong, E. & Munson, B. (2026). Comparing spectral shape and spectral moment measures in characterizing the sibilant-nonsibilant contrast in children's speech. *Meeting of the Acoustical Society of America*. Philadelphia, PA.

Munson, B. & **Wong, E.** (2026). Phonological Awareness and Coarticulation Revisited. *Meeting of the*

Acoustical Society of America. Philadelphia, PA.

- Wong, E.** & Munson, B. (2025). Is learning /r/ the same as learning to speak more clearly? The *6th Joint Meeting of the Acoustical Society of America and Acoustical Society of Japan*. Honolulu, HI.
- Wong, E.** & Munson, B. (2025). Early acoustic differentiation predicts later phonological knowledge. *The 6th Joint Meeting of the Acoustical Society of America and Acoustical Society of Japan*. Honolulu, HI.
- Wong, E.**, Johnson, E., Ebert, K. D., & Finestack, L. (2025). *Does English Proficiency Influence Dynamic Assessment Modifiability Ratings for Bilingual Children?* *ASHA Convention*. Washington, D.C.
- Zeng D., **Wong, E.**, Pickron, C. B., Munson, B., & Koenig, M. (2025). Understanding children's gender biases in language learning contexts. *The 50th Boston University Conference on Language Development (BUCLD)*. Boston, MA.
- Wong, E.** & Munson, B. (2025). Validating novel measures of sibilant fricatives using phoneme goodness ratings of children's speech. *The Journal of the Acoustical Society of America*, 157, A327.
- Ebert, K. D., Finestack, L., **Wong, E.**, & Johnson, E. (2025). Exploring Parent and Teacher Reports of Language Abilities of Spanish-English Bilingual Kindergarten Students. *Symposium on Research in Child Language Disorders*. Madison, WI.
- Wong, E.**, Pickron, C. B., Koenig, M., & Munson, B. (2025). The effect of adult gender on children's speech imitation. *Society for Research in Child Development 2025 Biennial Meeting*. Minneapolis, MN.
- Wong, E.**, & Munson, B. (2024). How do children learn to convey gender through speech? An acoustic analysis of child-directed speech. *International Congress for the Study of Child Language*, Prague, Czech Republic.
- Wong, E.**, & Munson, B. (2024). Gender-related variation in /s/ and /ʃ/ in child-directed speech. *The Journal of the Acoustical Society of America*, 155, A312.
- Wong, E.** & Munson, B. (2024). Learning gender variation in speech: an acoustic analysis of child-directed speech. *Cognitive Development Society Biennial Conference*. Pasadena, CA.
- Zeng, D., **Wong, E.** & Munson, B. (2024). Unveiling the complexity of gendered speech in early childhood: efficient rater sampling for precise ratings on 5-year-olds' gender. *Cognitive Development Society Biennial Conference*. Pasadena, CA.
- Wong, E.** & Munson, B. (2023). How do children mark gender phonetically? An analysis of voice quality. *International Congress of Phonetic Sciences 2023*. Prague, Czech Republic.
- Wong, E.** & Fung, R. (2023). What is a substantial voice? An LTAS study on two Cantonese accents. *International Congress of Phonetic Sciences 2023*. Prague, Czech Republic.
- Wong, E.** & Ebert, K. D. (2023). An alternative scoring method to reduce bias in nonword repetition for bilingual children. *Symposium on Research in Child Language Disorders*. Madison, WI.
- Ebert, K., Finestack, L., Kuchler, K. & **Wong, E.** (2023). Towards less-biased language assessment: Exploring dynamic and processing-based assessments in diverse bilingual children. *Symposium on Research in Child Language Disorders*. Madison, WI.
- Wong, E.** & Munson, B. (2021). A longitudinal study of gender-specific characteristics of children's vowels. *The Journal of the Acoustical Society of America*, 150(4), A152.

Oral Seminars and Invited Talks

- Wong, E.**, & Munson, B. (2025). Children's Selective Social Learning in Speech and Language: Foundations and Clinical Implications. Centennial Session at *ASHA Convention 2025*, Washington, D.C.
- Ebert, K. D., Finestack, L., Johnson, E., & **Wong, E.** (2024). *Assessing Language Skills of Multilingual Children with Variable Experiences: A Convergent Evidence Approach*. *ASHA Convention 2024*. Seattle, WA.

Fung, R. & **Wong, E. Y.-C.** (2017). The voice quality differences between Hong Kong Cantonese and Guangzhou Cantonese. *The 22nd JWLLP & The 5th Workshop on VariAMU*. The Hong Kong Polytechnic University, Hong Kong, April 8th, 2017

Fung, R. & **Wong, E. Y.-C.** (2017). The differences in voice quality between Hong Kong Cantonese and Guangzhou Cantonese. *UChicago Linguistic Research Forum*. The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Hong Kong, March 17th, 2017.

Teaching

Graduate Teaching Assistant

Speech-Language-Hearing Sciences, University of Minnesota

Courses taught:

SLHS 1301 Physics and Biology of Spoken Languages 2021- 2024

- Taught the laboratory portion of an undergraduate class on speech acoustics.
- Developed materials and assignments including worksheets, lab reports and discussion activities for weekly lab sessions.
- Graded assignments and exams.

SLHS 1402 The Talking Brain 2021

- Graded assignments and projects, facilitated in-class discussion activities.

SLHS 8430 Proseminar in Speech-Language-Hearing Sciences 2023

- Organized weekly seminar on topics related to research, teaching and career development for PhD students in Speech-Language-Hearing Sciences.

SLHS 3402 Capstone Project in Speech-Language-Hearing Sciences 2025

- Mentored and graded evidence-based practice research papers, service-learning journals and presentations.

Guest Lectures

SLHS 1301 Physics and Biology of Spoken Languages 2021- 2022

- Covered lectures on source-filter theory, consonant and vowel acoustics.

SLHS 3304 Phonetics 2023

- Covered lectures on stress, intonation and syllable structures, regional and global varieties of English.

SLHS 5609 Child Language Disorders in Diverse Populations 2023

- Covered lectures on bilingual language development, variations of English, and assessment for bilingual children.

Other Professional Experiences

Postdoctoral Research Associate

2026- present

DUAL Lab

Department of Speech, Language, and Hearing, University of Texas at Dallas

Research Project:

Longitudinal Study of Language Skills in Young Children at Risk of Developmental Language Disorder
(PIs: Anny Castilla-Earls)

Graduate Research Assistant

2022- 2026

Speech-Language-Hearing Sciences, University of Minnesota

Research Project:

Reliability and Validity of Dynamic and Processing-based Assessments for Language in Diverse Bilingual School-age Children (PIs: Kerry Ebert, Lizbeth Finestack)

- This is an NIH-supported longitudinal project that examines the efficacy of various linguistic and non-linguistic measures (dynamic assessment, standardized tests, and processing-based measures) in identifying language impairment in bilingual children.
- Conducted language assessments with multilingual children in school and home settings.
- Translated parent-caregiver interview questionnaires and assessment materials into Cantonese and Mandarin.
- Trained undergraduate research assistants, handled participant payment, and organized recruitment events.

Lab Manager (Assistant Technical Officer)

2016- 2020

Department of Chinese and Bilingual Studies, The Hong Kong Polytechnic University

- Assisted in the establishment of Speech and Language Sciences Lab.
- Managed lab equipment (Compumedics EEG, Tobii TX300 and Eyelink 1000 Plus eye-trackers, Soterix HD-tDCS, Karl Storz laryngoscopy, Glottal Enterprise EGG & aerodynamic system, Carstens AG501 Electromagnetic Articulograph).
- Maintained and troubleshooted daily lab operation.
- Assisted in conducting experiments, language and cognitive assessment to adults and children.
- Liaised with companies on purchasing lab equipment, consumables and maintenance services.
- Wrote up guidelines of lab equipment.
- Trained lab users.
- Conducted lab tours and demo of equipment to visitors and students.
- Designed and developed fun linguistics games and demo for lab events.

Research Assistant (concurrently with Lab Manager position)

2016- 2018

Department of Chinese and Bilingual Studies, The Hong Kong Polytechnic University

Projects:

A Physiological study on the voice quality and intonation of two regional accents of Cantonese: Articulatory and acoustic analyses (PI: Roxana Fung)

- Designed speech tasks.
- Collected acoustic and electroglottographic signals from 20 Hong Kong Cantonese and 20 Guangzhou Cantonese speakers.
- Performed analysis using spectral and cepstral measures, glottal parameters, LTAS and functional data analysis.
- Drafted conference and journal papers.

Pitch and Intonation of Hong Kong Cantonese and Guangzhou Cantonese (PI: Roxana Fung)

- Performed acoustic analysis of vowels, tones and voice quality on the speech recordings from 191 speakers of both gender and across three age groups from the two cities using VoiceSauce.
- Drafted conference and journal papers.

NLP Annotator, part-time, distance work

2014-- 2017

Nuance Communications, USA

- Annotated Cantonese data for developing advanced Natural Language Processing (NLP) models in linguistics technologies, question-answering and conversational systems.

Supports

Doctoral Dissertation Fellowship	2025- 2026
Graduate School, University of Minnesota (\$25,000)	

Charles E. Speaks Fellowship	2026
Department of Speech-Language-Hearing Sciences, University of Minnesota (\$3077)	

Dissertation Proposal Development Program	Summer 2023
College of Liberal Arts, University of Minnesota (\$4000)	

Interdisciplinary Doctoral Fellowship	2023- 2024
Graduate School, University of Minnesota (\$25,000)	

Summer Department Fellowships	2021- 2025
Department of Speech-Language-Hearing Sciences, University of Minnesota (\$3000 each summer)	

Bryng Bryngealson Student Research Funding	2021- 2024
Department of Speech-Language-Hearing Sciences, University of Minnesota	

Council of Graduate Studies Conference Grant	2021, 2023
University of Minnesota (\$900)	

Student Travel Award Recipient	2023
Symposium on Research in Child Language Disorders (SRCLD, \$700)	

Other Academic Training

Compumedics Hong Kong ERP Research & Clinical EEG Workshop. The Hong Kong Polytechnic University, Nov 7th- 10th, 2018.

Compumedics Clinical Curry School. The Hong Kong Polytechnic University, Oct 20th- 21st, 2017.

Services

Treasurer	2024- 2025
SCHWA: Student of Color Health + Wellbeing Alliance, University of Minnesota	

Council of Graduate Students Representative	2023- 2024
Department of Speech-Language-Hearing Sciences	

Skills

Acoustics	Praat, Computerized Speech Lab, Audacity
Data Management	RedCap
Statistics & Data Analysis	R, SPSS, Python
Neuroimaging	Compumedics Neuroscan, Biosemi, Curry 7, BESA
Experiment design	Qualtrics, E-prime, Experiment Builder, STIM2
Languages	Cantonese (native), English (fluent), Mandarin (fluent), Spanish (intermediate, DELE B1 certificate) Portuguese, French, German (basic)